

Collins Kimani

Penetration Tester | Cybersecurity Specialist

Cybersecurity practitioner with hands-on experience in penetration testing, secure backend development, and vulnerability assessment. Equipped with a growing track record of identifying security risks, building safe digital environments, and staying up to date with evolving cyber threats through consistent practice and collaboration.

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EXPERIENCE

Freelance Penetration Tester

Dec 2024 - date

- Gained hands-on experience in offensive security practices by participating in Capture The Flag (CTF) competitions and interactive labs (TryHackMe, Hack The Box).
- Conducted structured vulnerability assessments and authorized penetration tests across internal networks and web applications, using Nmap, Nessus, and Nikto.
- Performed web application security testing using Burp Suite, Caido, and OWASP ZAP, identifying common vulnerabilities such as SQLi, XSS, CSRF, and improper session handling.
- Simulated adversarial real-world attack scenarios in isolated lab environments using virtual machines and intentionally vulnerable applications (DVWA, Metasploitable, etc.).
- Developed Python and Bash automation scripts to streamline reconnaissance, password spraying, and report generation aligned with professional pentest workflows.
- Studied threat vectors to understand risks like phishing, credential stuffing, and insecure API handling.
- Authored detailed reports mirroring professional penetration testing standards, including technical findings, risk ratings (CVSS), and mitigation guidance.

Freelance Backend Engineer

Apr 2024 - date

- Designed and built secure backend systems using Flask (Python) with secure session handling and JWT-based authentication.
- Implemented Role-Based Access Control (RBAC) to manage user privileges, with a focus on preventing unauthorized access to sensitive data.
- Enforced secure coding practices: input validation, session expiry, password hashing, and secure cookie handling.
- Integrated both SQL (MySQL) and NoSQL (MongoDB) databases, following security best practices for queries and data storage.
- Wrote automated tests and documented the codebase to ensure reliability and maintainability of systems.

Freelance Web and Graphics Developer

Mar 2022 - May 2023

- Designed and built responsive websites using HTML, CSS, and JavaScript, working with small businesses and individuals.
- Applied branding principles and UX design to improve client engagement and trust through secure, user-friendly interfaces

SKILLS

- Web Security: *Burp Suite, OWASP ZAP, Caido, OWASP Top 10*
- Network Security: *Nmap, Wireshark, Nessus*
- Scripting: *Python, Bash, C*
- Authentication & Access Control: *JWT, RBAC*
- Lab & Simulation: *VirtualBox, Kali Linux, DVWA, Metasploitable*
- Standards & Frameworks: *CVE, CWE, CVSS, OWASP*
- Platforms: *TryHackMe, Hack The Box, Pwned Labs*
- Soft Skills: *Technical reporting, teamwork, attention to detail, ethical mindset*
- Exploit Development: *Reverse Engineering*

EDUCATION

Jommo Kenyatta University of Agriculture and Technology

Bsc. Computer Technology *Sep 2016 - Nov 2021*

CERTIFICATIONS

APIsec University

API Penetration Testing Course

Jun 2025 - present

Cisco NetAcad

Cisco Ethical Hacker (CEH)

Sep 2024 - Dec 2024

African Leadership X (ALX)

Certificate in Software Engineering

Jun 2023 - Oct 2024

REFEREES

Delivery upon Request